

Fresh Look At Water Crisis

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SHE MAY have tasted success with her first feature film, *Hemanter Pakhl*, but director Urmi Chakraborty returns to her first love this summer. While audiences are waking up to the call of Autumn Bird this sweltering summer, the director is busy canning her fifth documentary, *Water*.

This is not in line with the aborted Deepa Mehta project as the title suggests. Environmentalists worldwide picture a fresh water disaster in the near future. By 2025 some 17 countries including India will be hauled into the vortex of this crisis. Urmi chanced upon this piece of information on the net and immediately decided to take up the issue.

"One can't take water for granted. Every droplet is precious. And people should be aware of it," she says. From the parched lands of Rajasthan to the fertile climes of Sun-

derbans, the director traverses the entire length and breadth of India to capture its varied terrains and water resources. The documentary juxtaposes exquisite landscapes where water is abundant with the humdrum war over water in areas where it is scarce.

Urmi has roped in big stars for the documentary. Suresh Prabhu, Chairman, Task Force on inter-linking of rivers and Medha Patkar of the Narmada Bachao Andolon are all part of the film. The effect of population, global warming and unplanned agriculture on the water resources of the country is what the film deals with. The voiceover in the documentary is by Jagannath Guha, while Debojyoti Mishra provides the music.

The film is financed by Films Division. Urmi, who has previously won a National Award for her well-researched documentary, *Infiltrators*, hopes this film will be as well received.